

New start: on the Alaska summit and the Ukraine war

Ukraine's security concerns must be **addressed** for **lasting** peace

The **much-anticipated summit** between U.S. President Donald Trump and his Russian **counterpart** Vladimir Putin in Anchorage, Alaska, **did** not **yield** a **breakthrough** on the Ukraine war but appeared to **narrow** the gaps between their positions on how to end the conflict. While Ukraine was the most **contentious** issue on the **agenda**, the summit was **significant** for several reasons. **Relations** between the world's two largest nuclear powers **have** been defined by **hostility** and **mutual distrust**. A **stable, predictable** relationship and the **prospect** of a new **arms control pact** — **hinted at** by Mr. Putin — are **critical** not just for **stability** in Eastern Europe but also for broader global stability. Yet, **rebuilding** Russo-American **ties is inconceivable** without peace in Ukraine. **All sides** in the Ukraine war publicly **claim** that they are **committed to** peace, but they **differ** sharply on how to achieve it. Ukraine and its European partners have **called for** an immediate **ceasefire**, a demand **reiterated** by Mr. Trump before meeting Mr. Putin. Russia has **resisted** calls for a ceasefire, **insisting** instead on a **comprehensive** peace agreement that addresses what Mr. Putin calls the conflict's "root causes". Mr. Trump appeared to **endorse** the Russian line when he said "**the best way** to end the **horrific war**" **is** to go directly to a peace agreement.

While the **downside** of the summit was its failure to deliver a breakthrough, the positive side is that it opened a diplomatic path that could **lead to** conflict **resolution**. **Mr. Trump**, who claimed that he and Mr. Putin agreed on "many points", **spoke** with European, NATO and Ukrainian leaders after the meeting. Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy is expected to visit the White House on Monday to discuss Mr. Putin's proposal. Mr. Trump also suggested that it is now "up to Zelenskyy" to **strike a deal** with Russia, "a very big power". Russia has **consistently** made three **core** demands to end the war — **recognition** for the Ukrainian territories it has **annexed** and Ukraine's "**neutrality**" and "**demilitarisation**". Post-summit reports suggest that Mr. Putin is open to **freezing** the war along the **frontlines** in the south (Zaporizhzhia and Kherson) **provided** Russia retains full control of Donbas (Donetsk and Luhansk). A **settlement** could also involve Russian **withdrawal** in the northeast (Kharkiv). Ukraine has **so far** said that it would not **concede** land for peace. The **challenge** before Mr. Trump **is** to **sustain** the talks aimed at narrowing the differences further to reach a workable **compromise**. While it makes perfect sense to end the war on practical **terms**, Mr. Trump should not **impose** an agreement on Kyiv. Peace would **prevail** in Eastern Europe only if Ukraine's security concerns are addressed and it is provided with **credible assurances** that Russia would not **invade** it again.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

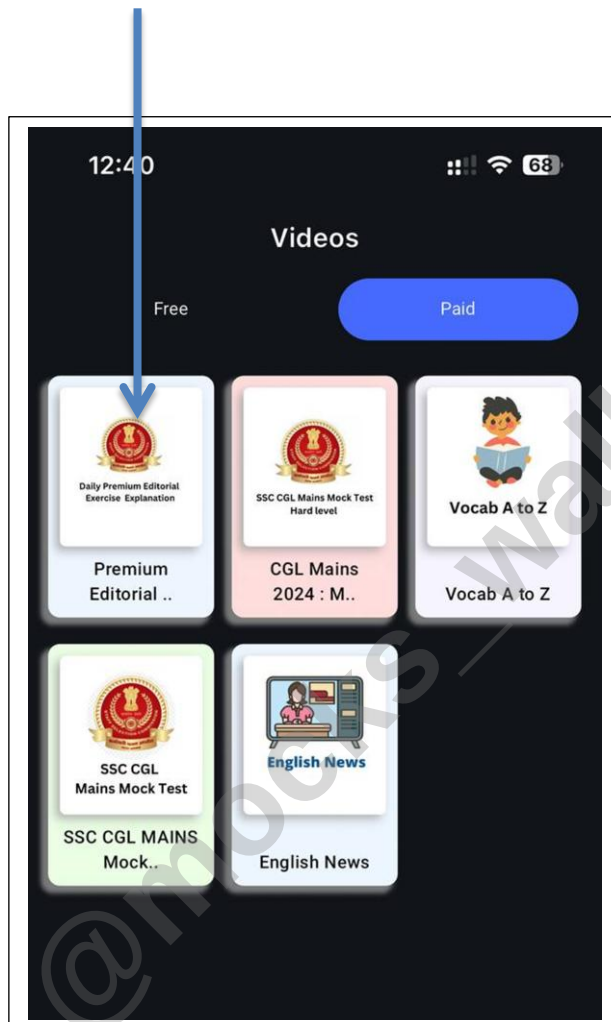
Vocabulary

1. **Summit** (noun) – high-level meeting, leaders' conference, top-level talks, conclave, summitry शिखर सम्मेलन
2. **Address** (verb) – tackle, deal with, confront, attend to, take up समाधान करना
3. **Lasting** (adjective) – enduring, durable, long-term, abiding, persistent दीर्घकालिक
4. **Much-anticipated** (adjective) – eagerly awaited, long-awaited, keenly expected, hotly awaited, widely expected बहुप्रतीक्षित
5. **Counterpart** (noun) – equivalent, opposite number, peer, parallel, match समकक्ष
6. **Yield** (verb) – produce, result in, deliver, generate, give परिणाम देना
7. **Breakthrough** (noun) – advance, major step, headway, milestone, game-changer महत्वपूर्ण सफलता
8. **Narrow** (verb) – reduce, shrink, lessen, close, bridge (अंतर) घटाना
9. **Contentious** (adjective) – controversial, disputed, divisive, debatable, polemical विवादास्पद
10. **Agenda** (noun) – program, schedule, docket, lineup, order of business कार्यसूची
11. **Significant** (adjective) – important, notable, substantial, meaningful, consequential महत्वपूर्ण
12. **Hostility** (noun) – animosity, enmity, antagonism, rancour, ill will शत्रुता
13. **Mutual** (adjective) – reciprocal, shared, joint, common, two-way परस्पर
14. **Distrust** (noun) – suspicion, mistrust, wariness, skepticism, lack of confidence अविश्वास
15. **Stable** (adjective) – steady, firm, reliable, secure, consistent स्थिर
16. **Predictable** (adjective) – foreseeable, expected, consistent, dependable, regular पूर्वानुमेय
17. **Prospect** (noun) – possibility, likelihood, outlook, chance, potential संभावना
18. **Arms** (noun) – weapons, armaments, munitions, ordnance, weaponry शस्त्र
19. **Pact** (noun) – treaty, agreement, accord, compact, deal समझौता
20. **Hint** (at) (verb) – suggest, allude to, imply, intimate, signal संकेत करना
21. **Critical** (adjective) – crucial, vital, essential, pivotal, key निर्णायक
22. **Stability** (noun) – steadiness, equilibrium, balance, constancy, security स्थिरता
23. **Ties** (noun) – relations, links, connections, bonds, relationship संबंध

24. **Inconceivable** (adjective) – unimaginable, unthinkable, implausible, beyond belief, impossible अकल्पनीय
25. **Committed** (to) (adjective) – dedicated to, pledged to, devoted to, wedded to, bound to प्रतिबद्ध
26. **Differ** (verb) – disagree, diverge, vary, contrast, be at odds भिन्न होना
27. **Call for** (phrasal verb) – demand, require, advocate, urge, press for मांग करना
28. **Ceasefire** (noun) – truce, armistice, cessation of hostilities, pause, cease-fire agreement युद्धविराम
29. **Reiterate** (verb) – repeat, restate, reaffirm, echo, iterate पुनः दोहराना
30. **Resist** (verb) – oppose, withstand, reject, fend off, defy विरोध करना
31. **Insist** (on) (verb) – demand, press for, require, emphasize, stick to आग्रह करना
32. **Comprehensive** (adjective) – all-encompassing, exhaustive, thorough, broad-based, sweeping व्यापक
33. **Endorse** (verb) – support, back, approve, ratify, champion समर्थन करना
34. **Horrific** (adjective) – terrible, dreadful, ghastly, appalling, horrifying भयावह
35. **Downside** (noun) – drawback, disadvantage, negative, cost, downside risk नकारात्मक पहलू
36. **Lead** (to) (verb) – result in, bring about, cause, give rise to, pave the way for वजह बनना
37. **Resolution** (noun) – settlement, solution, conclusion, fix, remedy समाधान
38. **Strike a deal** (phrase) – reach an agreement, make a bargain, come to terms, clinch a deal, hammer out an accord समझौता करना
39. **Consistently** (adverb) – steadily, regularly, unfailingly, uniformly, persistently लगातार
40. **Core** (adjective) – central, principal, key, fundamental, primary मूल
41. **Recognition** (noun) – acknowledgment, acceptance, admission, validation, approval मान्यता
42. **Annex** (verb) – seize, appropriate, incorporate, take over, absorb हड़प कर लेना
43. **Neutrality** (noun) – nonalignment, impartiality, non-belligerence, nonpartisanship, detachment तटस्थता
44. **Demilitarisation** (noun) – disarmament, demobilization, arms removal, de-

- weaponization, military drawdown सैन्य-मुक्ति
45. **Freeze** (verb) – halt, stop, suspend, immobilize, lock रोक देना
46. **Frontline** (noun) – battle line, front, forward line, contact line, line of control अग्रिम मोर्चा
47. **Provided** (conjunction) – if, on condition that, provided that, assuming that, so long as बशर्ते
48. **Settlement** (noun) – agreement, accord, deal, resolution, compromise समझौता
49. **Withdrawal** (noun) – pullout, retreat, disengagement, evacuation, drawdown वापसी
50. **So far** (phrase) – until now, thus far, to date, up to this point, hitherto अब तक
51. **Concede** (verb) – yield, cede, admit, grant, surrender मान लेना
52. **Sustain** (verb) – maintain, continue, uphold, keep up, prolong बनाए रखना
53. **Compromise** (noun) – middle ground, trade-off, accommodation, settlement, concessionary deal समझौता
54. **Terms** (noun) – conditions, provisions, stipulations, parameters, clauses शर्तें
55. **Impose** (verb) – enforce, levy, dictate, foist, inflict थोपना
56. **Prevail** (verb) – triumph, succeed, win out, dominate, persist कायम होना
57. **Credible** (adjective) – believable, trustworthy, reliable, plausible, dependable विश्वसनीय
58. **Assurance** (noun) – guarantee, pledge, promise, undertaking, commitment आश्वासन
59. **Invade** (verb) – attack, overrun, enter by force, encroach, storm आक्रमण करना

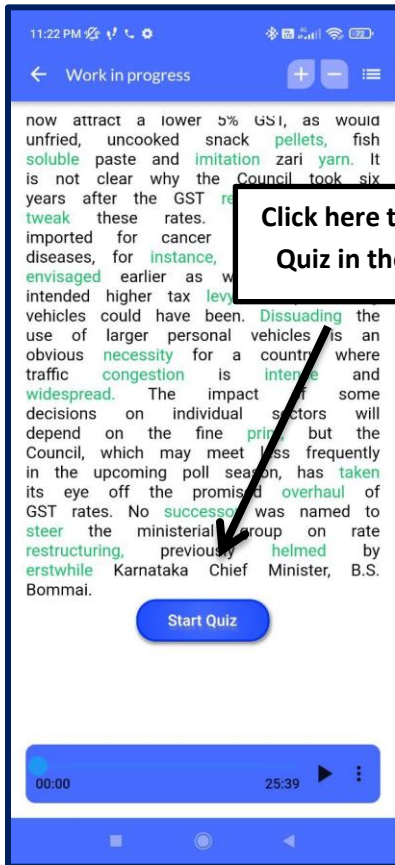
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



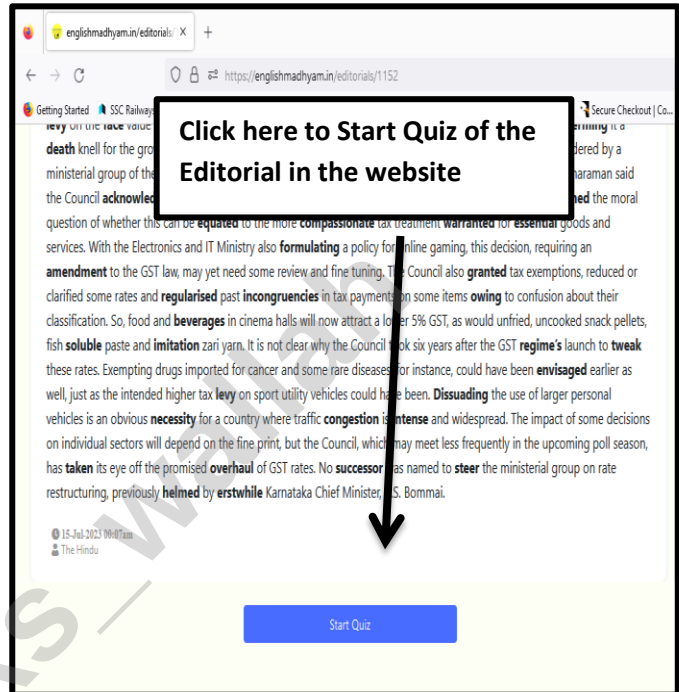
Summary of the Editorial

1. The U.S.–Russia summit in Anchorage between Donald Trump and Vladimir Putin did not produce a breakthrough on Ukraine but helped narrow differences.
2. Ukraine remained the central and most contentious issue on the agenda.
3. The meeting was significant given the hostile, distrustful history of U.S.–Russia relations.
4. A stable U.S.–Russia relationship and possible new arms control pact, hinted at by Putin, are vital for global stability.
5. Peace in Ukraine is essential before Russo-American ties can meaningfully improve.
6. All sides claim commitment to peace but differ on how to achieve it.
7. Ukraine and its European allies demand an immediate ceasefire, reiterated by Trump before the summit.
8. Russia rejects a simple ceasefire, insisting instead on a comprehensive agreement addressing the “root causes.”
9. Trump partly endorsed Russia’s stance, suggesting that peace must come through a full agreement, not just a ceasefire.
10. The summit’s failure to yield immediate results is offset by the opening of a new diplomatic path.
11. Trump held consultations with European, NATO, and Ukrainian leaders after the summit.
12. Ukrainian President Zelenskyy is set to visit Washington to discuss Putin’s proposals further.
13. Russia’s three main demands are: recognition of annexed territories, Ukrainian neutrality, and demilitarisation.
14. Reports indicate Putin might agree to freeze the war along southern frontlines if Russia keeps Donbas, while possibly withdrawing from Kharkiv.
15. A durable settlement requires addressing Ukraine’s security concerns and ensuring credible guarantees against future Russian aggression.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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